

Sony WF-C510

Favouring performance over features

After refreshing their premium and mid-range offerings in the TWS in-ear earphones last year, Sony has launched the Sony WF-C510, which comes in as the successor to their WF-C500, at almost exactly the same price.

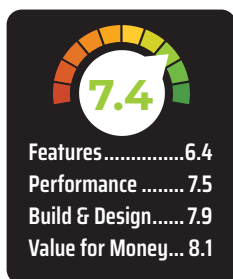
The earphones are a curious case of performance vs features, where Sony leans to the performance side, favouring the raw sound signature of the earphones over including features, that some might consider gimmicky. The choice for the consumers is tough. And, so was reviewing these earphones and passing a verdict. So, read on and find out how they fared in our tests and how they position themselves in the Indian market.

BUILD AND DESIGN

With the Sony WF C-510, Sony has gone with a sleek-looking case, which has nice pocketability and a heft to it. These in-ear earphones are a much-welcome departure from what the WF C series of TWS in-ear earphones we have seen over the years. You get a subtle design that fits well with all aesthetic choices. The branding is subtle on both the case and the buds, and you get what you'd expect from Sony, which has pushed boundaries in terms of keeping their designs subtle yet distinctive.

Coming to the choice of materials, Sony is pushing for sustainability in their earbud packaging and material, and the best part is that it does not compromise on the build quality. As I mentioned earlier, the case has a nice heft to it, with the hinge also having a satisfying snap. These in-ear earphones also have an IPX4 rating, meaning that you can get through light showers of rain or workouts easily.

₹4,990



As for the fit, you get a set of ear tips, which, in my experience, sufficed for a variety of different ear shapes and sizes. The general fit and design of the WF C series was one of the biggest reasons it was on my list of recommendations, despite not having all

the bells and whistles. And that trend of having an accessible fit for a wide variety of people, to my extreme delight, continues with these in-ear earphones. They are also lightweight, and you won't have any issues wearing them for long periods of time.

FEATURES

When looking at the features of the Sony WF-C510, you do not get the bells and whistles that you get on the more expensive in-ear earphones from Sony. There is no ANC, but transparency mode, which is a rather uncommon appearance on non-ANC earphones, is present on these in-ear earphones. More on this in the performance sec-

tion. Let's focus on what we get on these earphones.

In the Sony Headphones Connect app, you do not get a lot to play with when connected with the Sony WF-C510. In the app, there is an option to play around with Sony's 360 Reality Audio, and there's a 5-band EQ, which is about it. 360 Reality Audio adds a touch of immersion, and the EQ gives you some room to tinker with the audio; the presets are rather okay, but don't provide enough of a boost to the experience to write home about.

There are TWS options in the market, which will come in with a lot more features, including ANC, and as you will read later in the review, will race ahead of the Sony WF-C510 when it comes to its raw value for money.

PERFORMANCE

This is where the Sony WF-C510 reclaims all the lost ground.

These in-ear earphones are tuned with a consumer-friendly, balanced sound signature that avoids overpowering bass. The sound signature on these in-ear earphones leans towards neutrality, with a slight boost in the bass to keep things engaging without overwhelming the overall balance. This is a great choice for listeners who prefer an audio profile that's more versatile than the bass-heavy "fun" sound often found in budget in-ear earphones.

Bass: The low end on the WF-C510 is present but controlled, avoiding the overpowering or muddy bass that can sometimes dominate entry-level models. Bass is punchy enough to add a sense of rhythm and drive to tracks, especially in genres like pop and hip-hop, without bleeding into the midrange frequencies. For those who enjoy bass but don't want it to overshadow vocals and instruments, the WF-C510's approach is refreshing. However, listeners who are all about that deep, vibrating bass might find it slightly restrained.

Midrange: This is arguably the strength of the WF-C510, as Sony has